



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

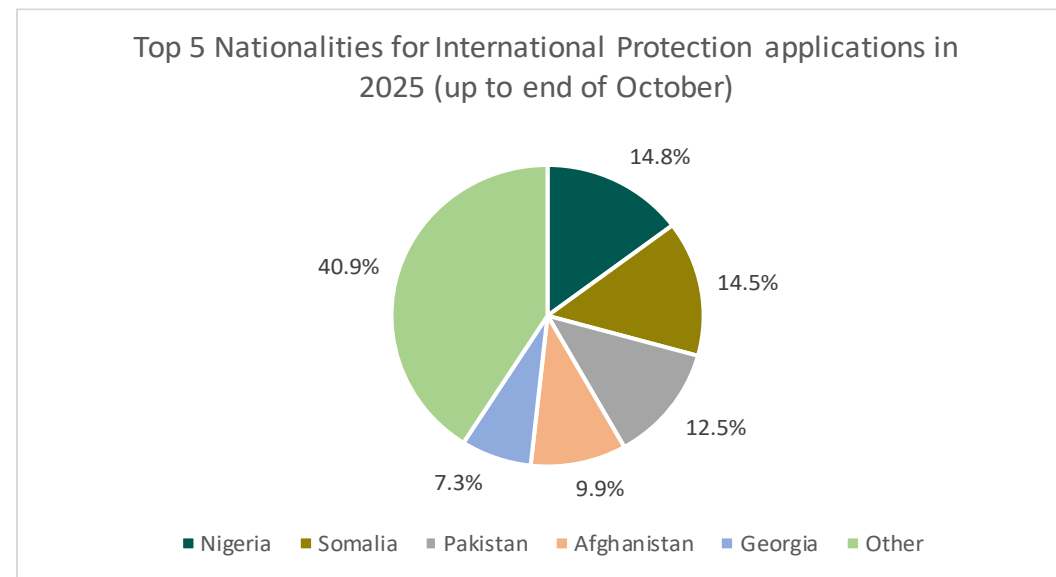
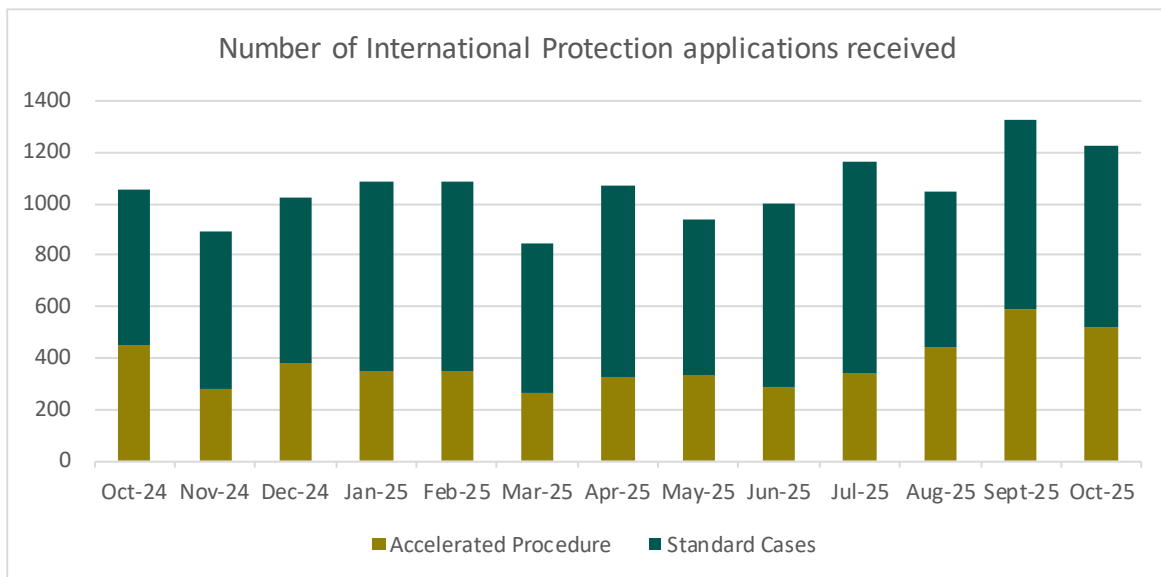
International Protection: October 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 5th November 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for October 2025:

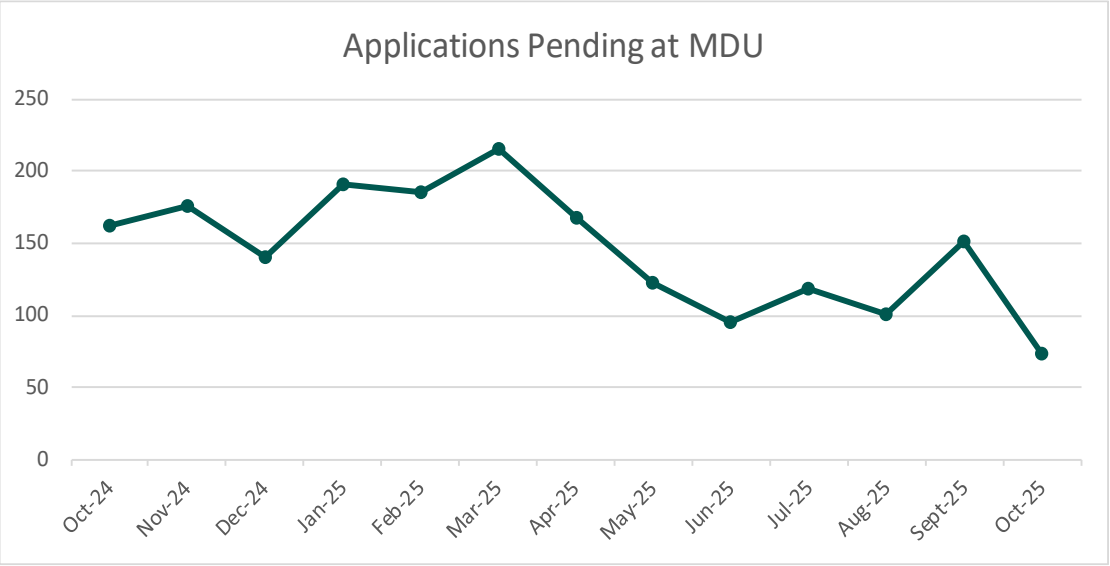
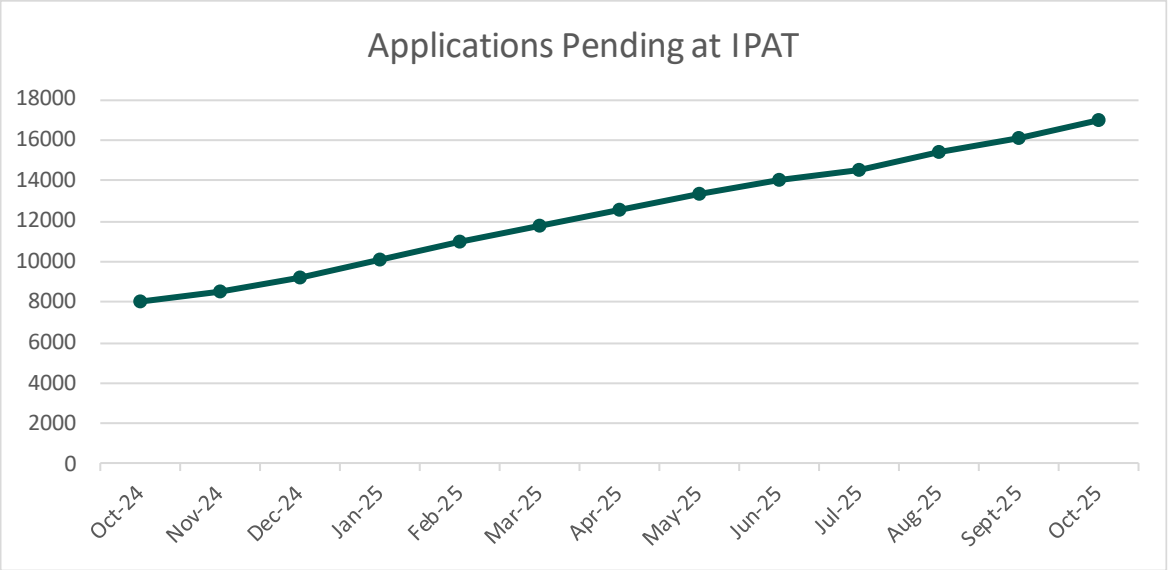
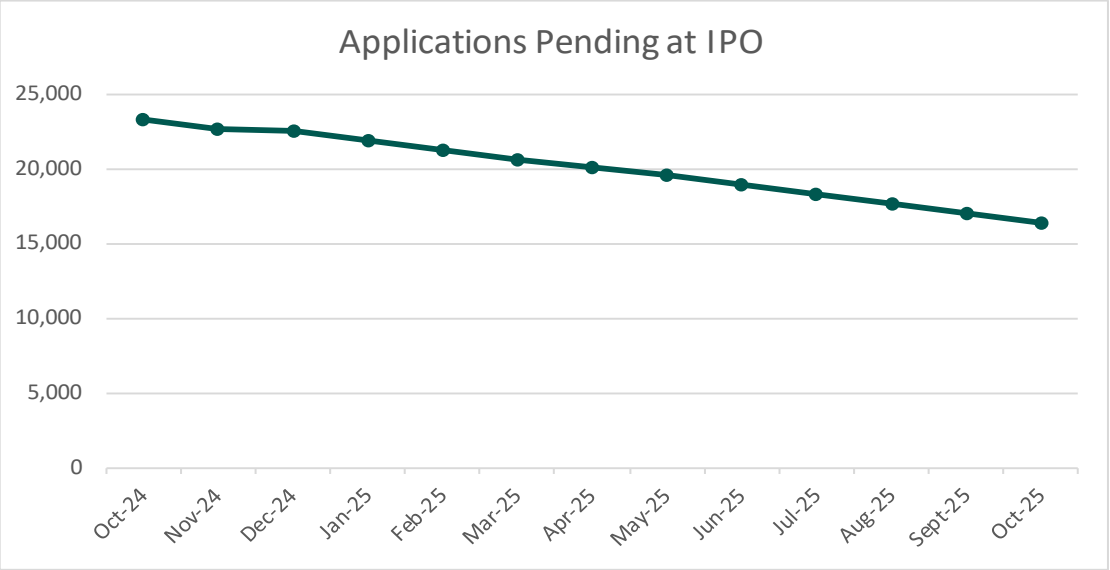
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has dropped significantly. In October 2025 there were 1,223 applications compared to 1,052 in October 2024. So far this year, through October, the total number of applications has dropped from 16,635 down to 10,812, a reduction of 35%
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (1,596 applications), Somalia (1,570), Pakistan (1,355), Afghanistan (1,072) and Georgia (792)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of October this year, there were 16,402 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been an increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In October 2025, 1,818 cases were closed off compared to 1,505 in October 2024
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has been trending slightly upwards in the last three months. In October 2025, the median processing time to determination was 76 weeks (compared to 73 weeks in April 2025 and 67 weeks in July 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO remains steady at 618 at the end of October 2025
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in October 2025 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 59% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 39% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



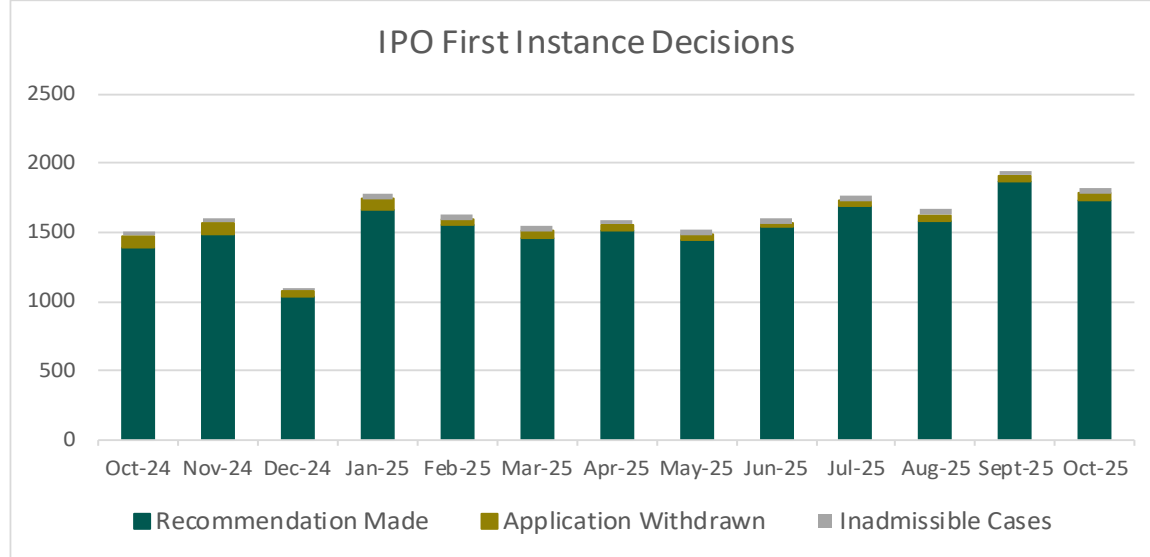
- In October 2025 there were 1,223 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,052 last October
- The total number of applications in October 2025 that fell under accelerated procedure was 519 (which represents 42% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (1,596 applications), Somalia (1,570), Pakistan (1,355), Afghanistan (1,072) and Georgia (792)

Pending International Protection Applications

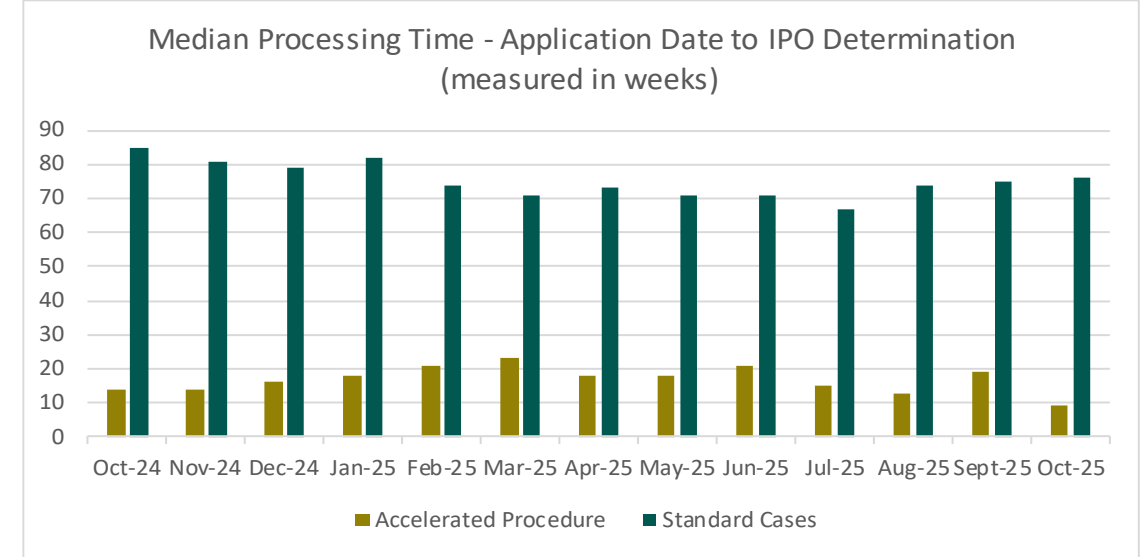


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 16,402. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In October 2025, there were 16,958 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of October 2025 is 73

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

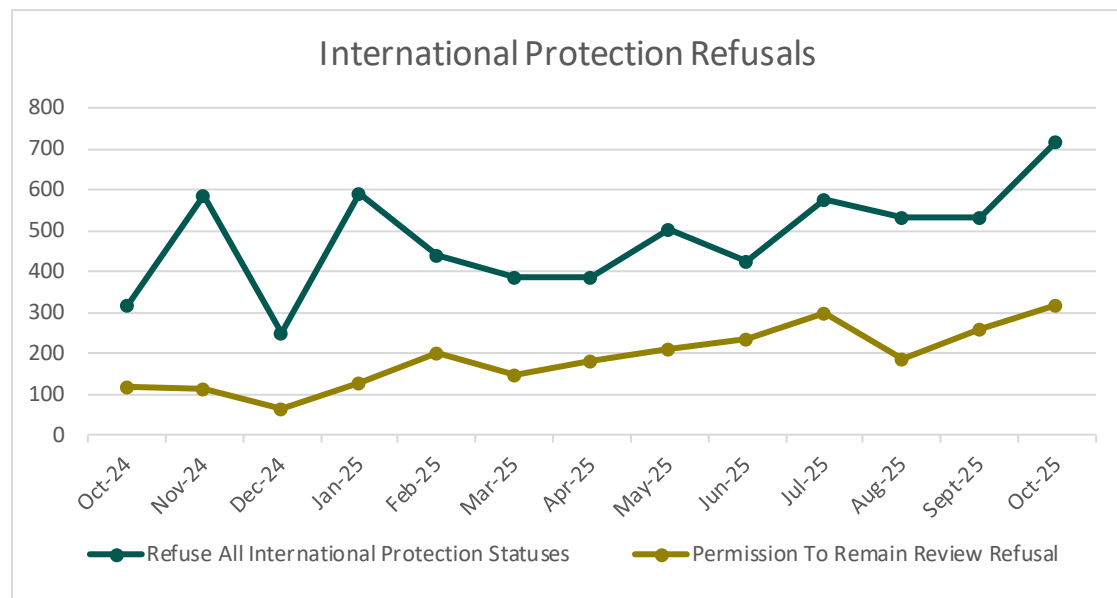
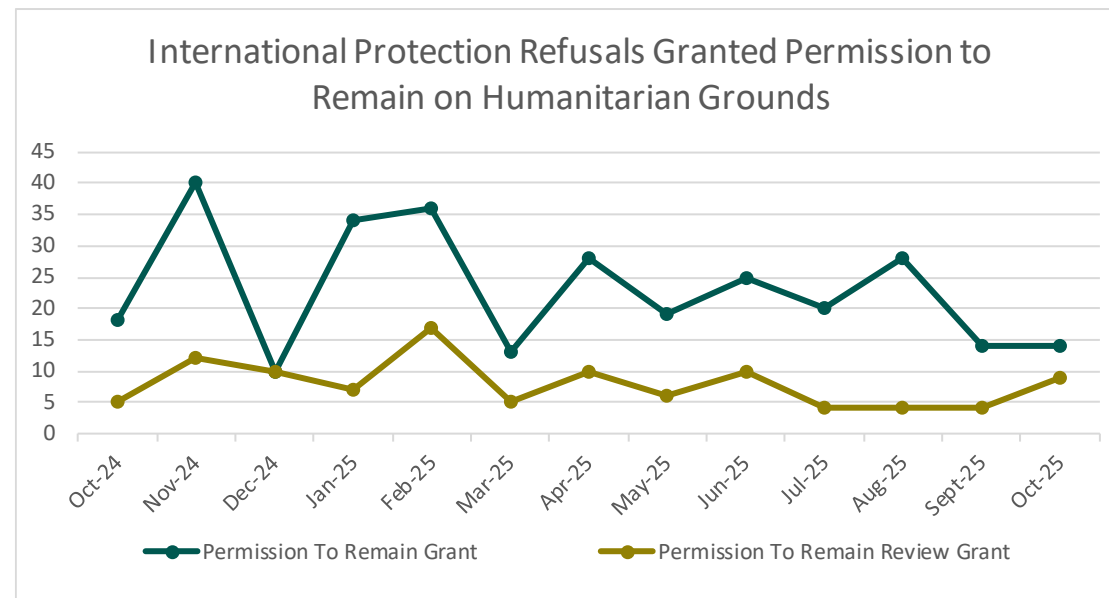
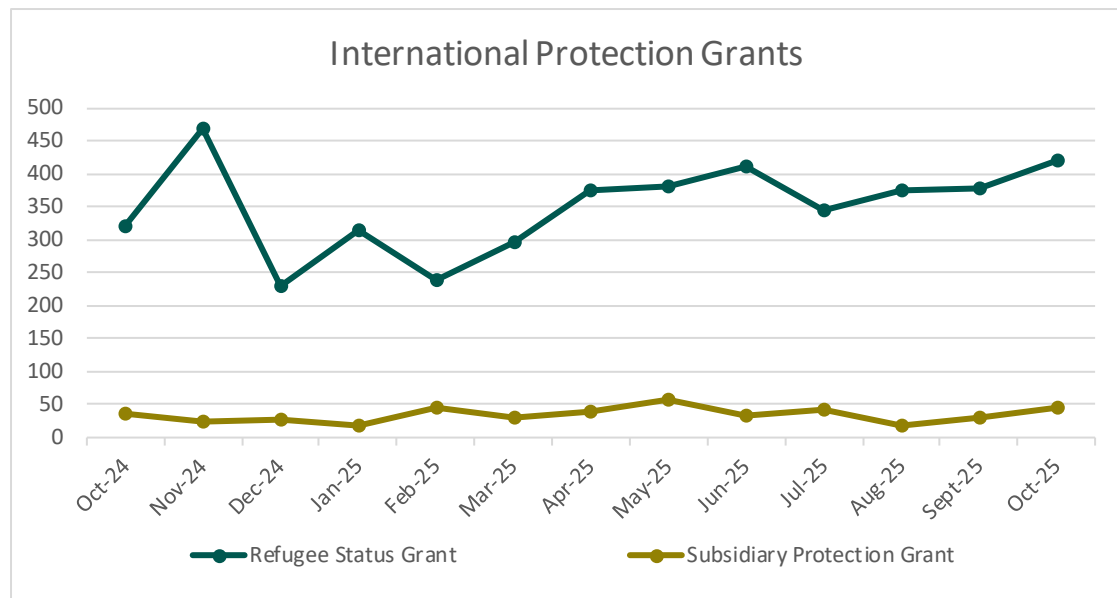


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In October 2025, 1,818 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,675 in August and down from 1,943 in September
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 16,863 (a 47.9% increase on 11,400 applications processed for 2024 YTD)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been increasing in the last three months for Standard Cases. There has been some fluctuation in the median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure, with the latest figures showing a decrease in October 2025
- In October 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 76 weeks (up from 73 weeks in April 2025 and 67 weeks in July 2025)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 9 weeks in October 2025, down from 13 weeks in August and 19 weeks in September

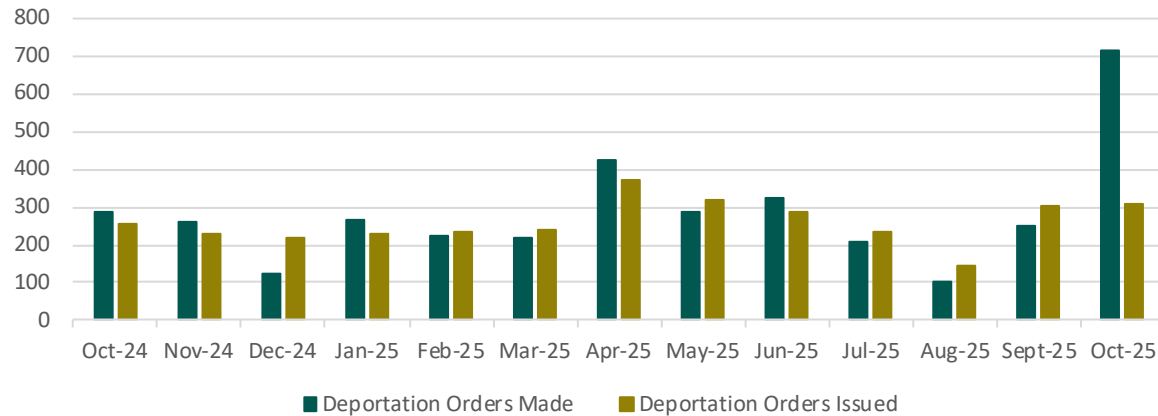
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In October 2025, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 421 were given refugee status grant and 44 subsidiary protection grant (465 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 14 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 9 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 717 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 319 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for October 2025, 59% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 39% were international protection grants

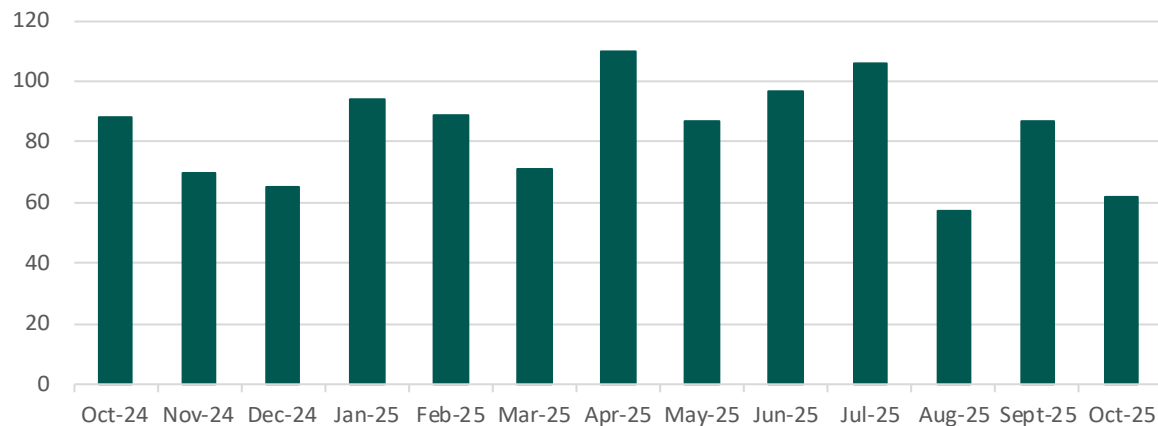
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

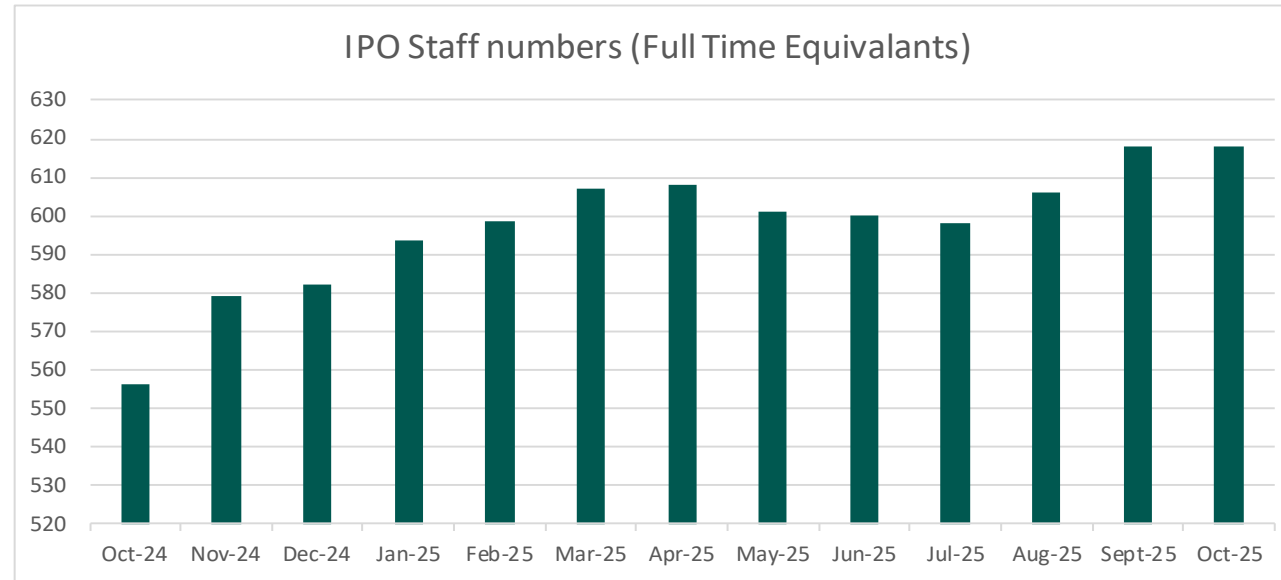


- For October 2025 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 712 and the number of deportation orders issued was 307. For September, the figures were 250 and 303, and for August, the figures were 105 and 147, respectively
- For October 2025 the number of removals was 62

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In October 2024 there were 556 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 608 in April 2025 and 606 in July 2025
- At the end of October 2025, the IPO had 618 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

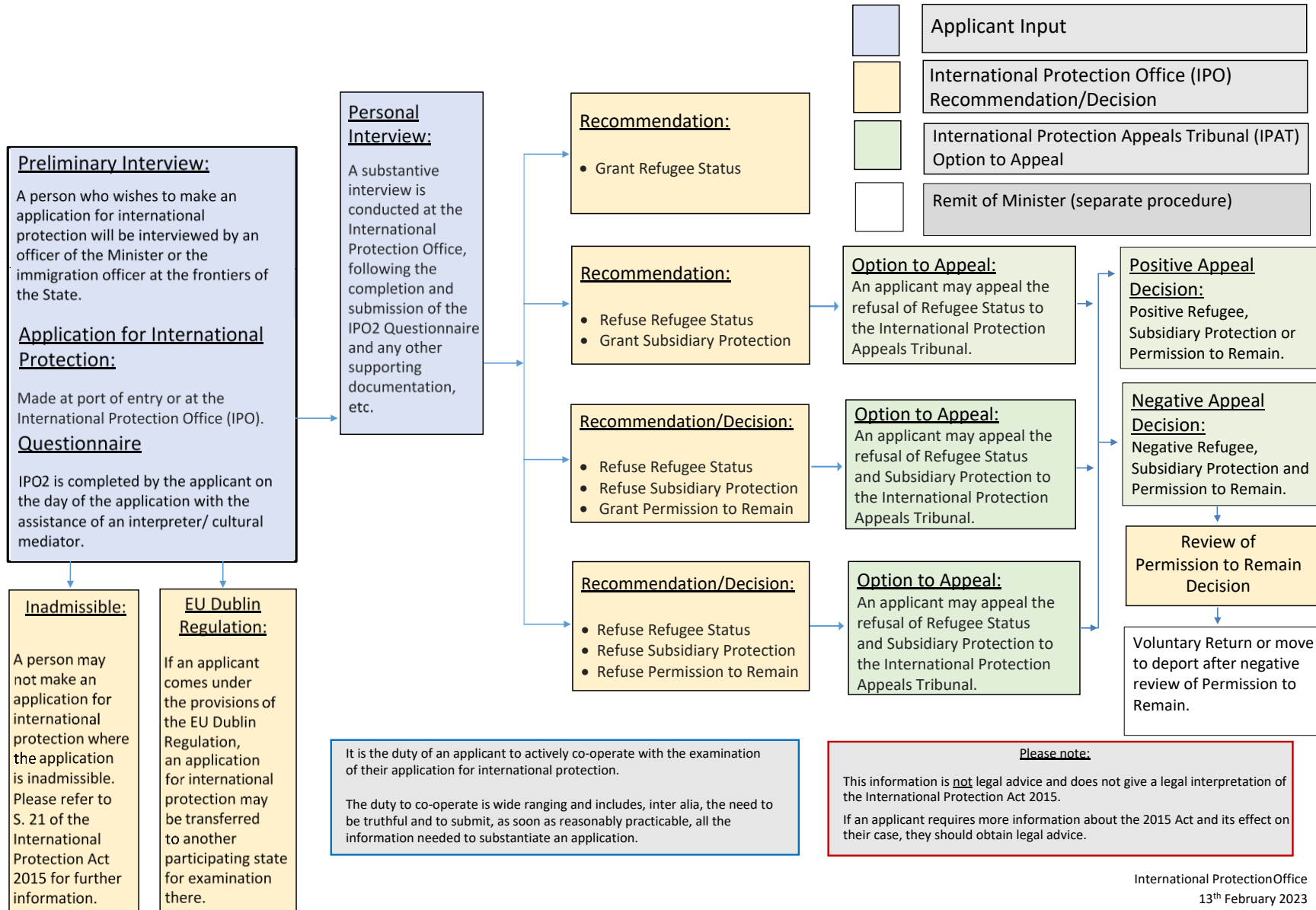
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
Accelerated Procedure	453	282	377	351	347	263	327	333	285	344	440	589	519
Standard Cases	599	613	647	734	742	586	748	610	717	821	611	741	704

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	1596	14.8%
Somalia	1570	14.5%
Pakistan	1355	12.5%
Afghanistan	1072	9.9%
Georgia	792	7.3%
Other	4427	40.9%
Total	10812	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
IP Pending	23,373	22,641	22,548	21,882	21,343	20,655	20,122	19,551	18,922	18,323	17,676	17,021	16,402
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
IPAT Pending	7,989	8,512	9,241	10,123	11,028	11,814	12,517	13,393	14,035	14,529	15,397	16,067	16,958

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
MDU Pending	162	176	141	191	186	216	168	123	95	119	101	152	73

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
Recommendation Made	1,393	1,491	1,038	1,658	1,555	1,464	1,517	1,443	1,537	1,689	1,589	1,875	1,736
Application Withdrawn	83	80	43	84	38	47	43	41	31	40	40	40	51
Inadmissible Cases	29	25	21	37	35	31	34	34	29	40	46	28	31

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
Accelerated Procedure	14	14	16	18	21	23	18	18	21	15	13	19	9
Standard Cases	85	81	79	82	74	71	73	71	71	67	74	75	76

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
Refugee Status Grant	321	469	231	315	239	298	374	382	413	344	375	379	421
Subsidiary Protection Grant	35	23	27	17	45	28	40	58	32	43	18	28	44
Permission to Remain Grant	18	40	10	34	36	13	28	19	25	20	28	14	14
Permission to Remain Review Grant	5	12	10	7	17	5	10	6	10	4	4	4	9

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	320	586	248	593	440	389	385	504	428	577	534	532	717
Permission to Remain Review Refusal	117	116	66	129	203	147	184	211	236	301	188	260	319

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
Deportation Orders Made	287	259	125	265	226	220	425	289	323	206	105	250	712
Deportation Orders Issued	254	230	219	229	236	237	369	320	289	235	147	303	307

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
Enforcements/Returns*	88	70	65	94	89	71	110	87	97	106	57	87	62

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sept-25	Oct-25
IPO Staffing Levels	556.3	579.1	582.1	593.4	598.8	607	608	601	600	598	606	618.2	618.2